



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Westminster Academy Tampa
School Website: <https://westminstertampa.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Westminster Academy Tampa (33609) presents a coherent classical Christian program that foregrounds character formation, virtue, and faith-integrated inquiry. Public materials consistently tie education to truth, goodness, and beauty, with a stated aim of forming wise, virtuous ambassadors who root knowledge in a biblical worldview. The school positions itself as classical in orientation, emphasizes classical literature and primary sources, and describes teaching as a “living curriculum” informed by Christian faith. There is clear evidence of strong parental involvement and active community engagement (Open Houses, SALT Day, and various parent-partnering activities). While the site emphasizes classical methods and virtue-centered aims, it does not always spell out every specific hallmark of a full six-element classical rubric (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and some Socratic pedagogy in every grade). Overall, Westminster Academy Tampa aligns with the Classical/Christian rubric more strongly than not, and the aggregate evaluation is CLASSICAL.

Key insights:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit: biblical worldview, theology-infused instruction, and a stated aim to form hearts and minds by truth, beauty, and goodness. Positive signals dominate; theological framing is explicit.
- Purpose and goals center on formation of virtue and wisdom, not primarily job training; the school emphasizes formation and a teleology toward truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian framework.
- Curriculum highlights classical elements: classic literature, historical texts, and primary sources are foregrounded; explicit Great Books language is not always stated on the site, which tempers the “classical” completeness in this category.
- Pedagogy shows elements of classical teaching (memory, rhetoric, and disciplined, contemplative aspects via scholé-like rhythms in places), though explicit Socratic seminars across the upper school are not repeatedly stated in the public materials.
- Faculty portrayal leans into model teachers and mentors, with named faculty and a head of school who frame learning as a faith-informed, virtuous enterprise.
- Parents and community engagement is a strength: documented partnership with parents, open houses, and active volunteerism (Chapel, Dad’s Curb Service, etc.) alongside community service (SALT).

ABSTRACT

of classification: The school demonstrates robust alignment with the Classical education rubric in Religious Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community; it shows strong alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy, though with some gaps (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and fully described Socratic seminar structures). The aggregate classification, taking all six categories into account, is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly frames its identity as classical and Christian, stressing that minds and hearts are engaged and transformed by truth, beauty, and goodness.
- Founding statements emphasize thinking biblically in all areas of life and a biblically grounded worldview.
- Official value statements foreground Biblical Fidelity, Devotional Vitality, and Intellectual Integrity.
- Public materials articulate a biblical, theology-informed approach to education and faith integration (Scripture as the guide for faith and life).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present in public materials: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; biblical worldview; Scripture; devotional vitality; intellectual integrity. These terms appear across the Welcome/About pages and value statements.
- Negative keywords (from the lexicon) such as relativism, secular humanism, values clarification are not evident in the public materials. The content instead foregrounds a biblically grounded approach.

Why this rating

- The combination of explicit references to truth/beauty/goodness, explicit theology/ Scripture integration, and a stated Christian mission anchors the school clearly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in a classical sense. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission and vision center on forming virtue and wisdom, not primarily job preparation. The organization speaks of forming minds and hearts through truth, beauty, and goodness; “wise, virtuous ambassadors” are the aim.
- The vision emphasizes formation, human flourishing, and a classical mission grounded in a Christian framework.
- Statements emphasize education as a humane, lifelong pursuit of learning, anchored in a biblical worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical mission, liberal education, great conversation (implicit in classical framing), truth/goodness/beauty. Explicit phrases include “formation of virtue and wisdom” and “wise, virtuous ambassadors.”
- Negative keywords are not present in the public materials (e.g., no emphasis on “workforce preparation” as the primary aim).

Why this rating

- The school’s core purpose aligns with the classical-pedagogical goal of forming character and intellect toward truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian frame, which matches the CLASSICAL rubric for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Curriculum emphasis is on classic literature, historical texts, and primary sources as central elements; public materials state: “curriculum includes classic literature, historical texts, and primary sources” and that classical teaching methods are used.
- The site describes a classical approach to thinking deeply, engaging with ideas, and developing analytical skills.
- There is mention of a robust classical framework in core sections (Classical, Christian) and in Fine Arts referencing study of classical artists and plays with memorization and rhetorical skills.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: classical teaching methods, classic literature, historical texts, primary sources, modern emphasis on deep engagement with ideas.
- Notable gaps relative to the strict six-element rubric: explicit reference to Great Books and the Great Conversation is not consistently stated on the site; nor is there a clear, repeated listing of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as canonical trinity in the curriculum within public-facing content. (One can infer rhetoric-related work in Fine Arts, but explicit triad grammar-logic-rhetoric is not repeatedly named in public copy.) This makes the category weaker than a full “Classical” designation based strictly on the rubric’s curriculum bullets. See public content: “classic literature, historical texts, and primary sources” and “classical teaching methods.”

Why this rating

- The school strongly foregrounds classic, liberal-arts content and primary sources, which aligns with classical education. However, the explicit framing around the traditional triad of grammar-logic-rhetoric, and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language, is not consistently documented in the public materials. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site advertises “classical teaching methods” and emphasizes deep thinking and engagement with ideas.
- Fine Arts section notes memorization and development of rhetorical skills within drama, indicating an emphasis on rhetoric and memory work in pedagogy.
- Higher-level pedagogy imagery includes trained teachers and a focus on forming virtue and thoughtful engagement; the exact articulation of Socratic seminars or scholé days is not repeatedly stated in public copy, though the classical approach is evident.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion/seminars (not explicitly named, but the school’s classical approach implies discussion-based inquiry in many contexts), memory work, recitation, rhetoric, debate, remembrance (as seen in Fine Arts and curriculum language). The site explicitly notes memorization and rhetorical skill development in drama.
- Negative keywords from the lexicon (e.g., “experiential learning focus” or sole project-based learning without classical grounding) are not a stated feature of Westminster’s public materials; but explicit, codified Socratic seminars and scholé days are not consistently documented. This yields a partial alignment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- There is clear evidence of classical pedagogy elements (memory work, rhetoric, classical content) but less explicit, consistent articulation of all six classical pedagogical markers (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, formalized memory- and dictation-oriented practices). Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents a roster of dedicated, credentialed faculty and a Head of School; the faculty is described in terms of mentorship and virtue, with public bios highlighting professional experience and faith commitments. Examples include Martha Crane (Head of School) and teachers across grade levels.
- The public framing presents the faculty as a living part of the school's mission and identity; the "classical-Christian" framing is reinforced by the biographies and the headship.
- The values and mission emphasize that the faculty constitute the core of the school's vision, aligning with the classical notion of a living curriculum manifested by teachers who model virtue and knowledge.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers and mentors; faculty as core; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; teachers as guides in a Christian, classical setting. These terms are reflected in public-facing bios and statements.
- Negative keywords (from the lexicon) such as "certification-driven jargon without classical context" are not evident in public materials; the site emphasizes a classical, faith-based faculty identity.

Why this rating

- The presence of named, credentialed faculty, a clear leadership structure, and a culture described as mentoring and virtue-driven supports CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school foregrounds partnership with parents and views parents as co-teachers; there are explicit "Ways to Become Involved," family events, and community-facing activities.
- The admissions and outreach content emphasizes open houses and opportunities for parent involvement; publicly listed events invite parent participation (Open House, service days, etc.).
- Service and community engagement (SALT Day) demonstrate a community-oriented, faith-based citizenship dimension that many classical programs emphasize.
- The school's website shows active parental engagement through volunteer opportunities, chapel involvement, and family events.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, family involvement, chapel, community service, SALT Day. These are explicitly present on the site.
- Negative keywords: none noted in public content.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates strong, explicit engagement with parents and the surrounding community in a classical-faith frame, aligning with the CLASSICAL designation for this category.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the aggregate CLASSICAL designation. The school already demonstrates strong alignment across most categories and robust parental/community integration. If one sought to advance to a fuller, explicit alignment with the strictest classical rubric in Curriculum and Pedagogy, it could consider:

- Explicitly signaling Great Books/Great Conversation as core components (e.g., naming canonical Great Books texts and describing student participation in Great Conversation-style discourse in appropriate grades). Evidence would include explicit language about Great Books and Great Conversation across grade levels.
 - More explicit articulation of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as the core triad of classical pedagogy in public materials, with examples of graded activities (grammar-school Latin, logic puzzles, rhetoric exercises, or formal declamation) clearly described on the site.
 - Additional depiction of scholé/restful learning days or contemplative-isolated study rhythms to align with scholé language in the classical lexicon.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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